made to be temporary bodies such as the UNHCR, they have nevertheless become permanent organs. The UN also has a hybrid set of subsidiaries and partners and throughout its history it has been associated with almost three thousand non-governmental Organisations.

Envisioned in 1945 in article 77 of the UN Charter, it states explicitly that the UN 'may make suitable arrangements for consultation with nongovernmental Organisations which are concerned with matters within its competence'. This made it possible for the UN to work with hundreds of NGOs to undertake humanitarian work in conflict zones, for example, the UN Mission in Bosnia and Herzegovina(UNMIBH) between 1995-2002. In 2007, thirty-two NGOs issued an open letter to the Secretary General to pressurize Sudan's government to permit a Joint African Union/United Nations Peacekeeping force to enter the conflict-ridden Darfur region. In the following sections, some of the important organs of the United Nations such as the International Monetary Fund, the World Bank and international Organisations such as Asian Development Bank, Amnesty International and Human Rights Watch would be examined.

The ECOSOC under the UN mandate coordinates the economic and social work of the UN and the UN family of Organisations. It therefore plays a key role in fostering international cooperation for development. While the Security Council was charged with weighty issues of military security, the ECOSOC was left to deal with questions of economic security. However, these were not to be taken lightly as many who were involved in the drafting of the UN Charter considered the great economic depression during the 1930s as the root cause for the second World War. The ECOSOC although a relatively powerless body of the UN structure, oversees a number of functional and regional commissions. The Commission on Human Rights monitors the observance of human rights across the world. Other bodies focus on social development, the status of women, environmental protection, crime prevention and narcotic drugs. However, the ECOSOC's mission continues to remain amorphous. The true global economic power infact lies with the so called three sisters (i) the World Bank (ii) The International Monetary Fund and (iii) the World Trade Organisation.

11.4 The World Bank



The World Bank which is based in Washington, was originally known as the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD). The World Bank or often referred to as the Bank Group was founded in 1945 and serves as the largest source of funding and knowledge for developing countries in the world. The term "world bank" was first used in reference to IBRD in an article in the Economist on July 22, 1944, in a report on the Bretton Woods Conference. The primary focus of the Bank is to work with the poorest people and the poorest countries through its five

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